

CHAPTER 7

Elections

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples: write your own.

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The Big Questions

1 Why are elections essential to a democratic system?

✔ ANSWER

- Regular, periodic elections lie at the core of democracy.
- Through our vote we choose those who will make decisions on our behalf.
- They keep elected representatives **accountable** to the people; a government cannot continue beyond its term without a fresh mandate.
- They give every citizen an equal voice in forming the government (representation, equality, legitimacy).

2 How do electoral systems and rules shape political representation and fairness?

✔ ANSWER

- The electoral system decides how votes are converted into seats.
- In **FPTP** (used for Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha) the candidate with the most votes wins, even with less than 50% of votes.
- In a **majority system** a winner needs more than 50%, so there may be a second round.

- In **proportional representation** seats are given in proportion to votes, so power is shared (used for Rajya Sabha, President, Vice President, Vidhan Parishad).
- Delimitation keeps the ratio of seats to population nearly equal, so each vote has similar value.

3 **What role do institutions and laws play in ensuring free and fair elections?**

✔ ANSWER

- **RPA 1950**: seats, delimitation, electoral rolls, right to vote for every citizen of 18+.
- **RPA 1951**: nominations, campaigns, voting, disputes; lists electoral offences and corrupt practices.
- **Delimitation Commission** fixes constituency boundaries for equal representation.
- **Election Commission of India** prepares electoral rolls, fixes the schedule, registers parties and allots symbols, and ensures free, fair and inclusive elections.

4 **What challenges do elections face in practice, and how can these challenges affect democracy?**

✔ ANSWER

- Very large scale: over 96.8 crore voters (2024), thousands of polling stations, hundreds of parties.
- Misinformation, fake news, intimidation, influence of money and favours, inaccurate counting, and difficulty for some voters to reach the booth.
- These reduce the democratic value of elections and can weaken public confidence in electoral institutions.
- The ECI tackles them through the RPA, Model Code of Conduct, EVMs, VVPAT and voter awareness; citizen vigilance also helps.

? Why do Elections Matter? · In-text questions

? Can Gurmat continue as CR in Grade 9 without facing a fresh election?

Can the government continue beyond the prescribed term without seeking the people's mandate again?

Can we exercise our choice if only one political party is contesting the election?

✔ ANSWER

No to all three.

Democracy needs periodic elections of those who make decisions for us. Representatives must face voters again to stay accountable, and a real choice needs more than one party.

Fig. 7.1 **Fill in the two empty boxes to show why elections are important for democratic functioning (given: Accountability, Representation, Equality, Legitimacy), and discuss how each is ensured through elections.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Possible boxes: **Participation** and **Peaceful change of government** (or Choice).

- Accountability: representatives must face voters again after five years.
- Representation: people choose who speaks for them.
- Equality: one person, one vote, equal value.
- Legitimacy: a government chosen by the people has the right to rule.
- Participation: every adult citizen takes part in decision-making by voting.
- Peaceful change: a non-performing government can be replaced by votes.

⭐ Let's Explore · The Electoral System

1 **In groups, select six countries from different continents. Prepare a case study on their electoral system(s) and discuss their latest election results.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample case study points:

Country	Continent	Electoral system
India	Asia	FPTP (Lok Sabha)
United Kingdom	Europe	FPTP
France	Europe	Two-round majority system
South Africa	Africa	Proportional representation (party list)
Brazil	South America	Proportional representation for lower house; two-round for President
Australia	Oceania	Preferential voting (lower house), single transferable vote (Senate)

For each country add the latest election results from official/news sources.

⭐ Don't Miss Out · Delimitation Commission

? Can you find out the reason for the long interval between 1973 and 2002 (Delimitation Commissions)?

✔ ANSWER

In 1976 the 42nd Constitutional Amendment froze the number of seats on the basis of the 1971 Census till the 2001 Census.

This was done so that states that controlled their population would not lose seats. So no new delimitation took place until after 2001.

🤔 Think About It · Election Commission of India

1 **Find out the steps of registration as a voter and the required documents. Discuss with someone who has just registered the ease or difficulty faced.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Steps (sample):

- Fill **Form 6** online on the Voter Service Portal / Voter Helpline App, or offline with the Booth Level Officer (BLO).
- Upload/attach a photo, proof of age and proof of address.
- The BLO verifies the details; name is added to the electoral roll and the EPIC (voter ID) is issued.

Documents: passport-size photo; age proof (birth certificate, Class 10 certificate, Aadhaar, etc.); address proof (Aadhaar, ration card, bank passbook, electricity bill, etc.).

Discussion: online registration is easy and quick, but some face delays in verification or lack of documents.

⭐ Let's Explore · ETPBS

1 **Find out who are classified as service voters and who can vote using ETPBS.**

✔ ANSWER

Service voters are: members of the armed forces; members of armed police forces of a State serving outside that State; government employees posted outside India (e.g., in Indian embassies); and the wife of such a person living with them.

ETPBS is used by service voters, who receive the postal ballot electronically and cast their vote from outside their constituency.

⭐ Let's Map · Political Parties

1 **Choose any three states (including yours). Find the symbols of their state parties, plot them on the map of India and list their major agenda from their latest manifesto.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample (complete with your own state):

State	State party	Symbol
Tamil Nadu	Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK)	Rising sun
West Bengal	All India Trinamool Congress (AITC)	Flowers and grass
Odisha	Biju Janata Dal (BJD)	Conch

Major agenda: read each party's latest manifesto (e.g., welfare schemes, jobs, farmers, education, state rights) and write 2–3 points for each.

2 **In groups, compare the policy preferences of two political parties in the last Lok Sabha Elections on Education, National security, Social welfare, Environment, Economy and Health (party's viewpoint, a policy/law that aligns with it, source). Present as a poster.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Make a table with the columns: Policy area | Party's viewpoint | Policy/law that aligns | Source.

Take each party's viewpoint from its 2024 manifesto; check news reports for related laws or schemes; write the source (manifesto, newspaper name and date) in the last column.

Use bullet points, party symbols and colour coding for each party on the poster.

⭐ Let's Explore · Party Recognition

1 **Find out the number of State parties and Registered Unrecognised Political Parties (RUPP). You may visit the website of ECI.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Check the latest list of political parties on the ECI website (eci.gov.in).

There are only a few national parties, a few dozen recognised State parties, and the large majority (over two thousand) are RUPPs. Write the exact numbers from the latest ECI notification.

⭐ Let's Explore · Coalition Politics

1 **Find out the name and composition (national and state parties) of the alliances that won the Lok Sabha elections of 1977, 1999, 2004, 2009, 2014, 2019 and 2024.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Year	Alliance won	Main national party	Some state/other partners
1977	Janata Party	Janata Party (Congress (O), Bharatiya Lok Dal, Jana Sangh, Socialists merged)	Allies such as Akali Dal, CPI(M) (outside)
1999	NDA	BJP	Shiv Sena, JD(U), DMK, BJD, TDP (support)
2004	UPA	INC	RJD, DMK, NCP, JMM; Left parties supported from outside

2009	UPA	INC	AITC, DMK, NCP, National Conference
2014	NDA	BJP	Shiv Sena, TDP, LJP, SAD
2019	NDA	BJP	Shiv Sena, JD(U), LJP
2024	NDA	BJP	TDP, JD(U), Shiv Sena, LJP (Ram Vilas), JD(S)

Check the full number of partners on the ECI website or newspapers.

⭐ Let's Analyse · Challenges to Free and Fair Elections

1 **Fill in the empty potholes (Fig. 7.13: Intimidation, Misinformation, Fake News) with more challenges. How can we overcome them?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

More challenges: money power, distributing gifts/liquor, appeals on caste or religion, booth capturing, low voter turnout, criminals as candidates, errors in electoral rolls.

How to overcome:

- Strict use of the Model Code of Conduct and RPA 1951; report violations on the **cVIGIL** app.

- EVMs and VVPAT for accurate counting; police and flying squads at booths.
- Voter awareness campaigns; fact-checking news before sharing.
- SIR to keep electoral rolls correct; citizens voting and staying alert.

? Questions and activities

1 (a) What reforms have been introduced by the ECI to make voting more inclusive for People with Disabilities?

✔ ANSWER

- EVMs with Braille; ramps, wheelchairs and volunteers at polling stations.
- **Saksham App** for registration, finding the polling station, etc.
- Voting from home for PwDs with a benchmark disability of 40% (extended across India in the 2024 General Elections).

1 (b) ... Service Voters?

✔ ANSWER

ETPBS (Electronically Transmitted Postal Ballot System): service voters receive the postal ballot electronically and cast their vote from anywhere outside their constituency.

1 (c) **... Senior Citizens above 85 years of age?**

✔ ANSWER

Voting from home for senior citizens above 85 years, extended across India for the first time in the 2024 General Elections.

1 (d) **... Prisoners?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Under the RPA 1951, a person confined in prison (serving a sentence or in lawful police custody) cannot vote.

So prisoners are not given a voting facility; the law keeps this rule to keep criminal influence away from elections.

1 (e) **... Persons in preventive detention?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

A person under **preventive detention** is not a convict, so he/she keeps the right to vote and can vote through a **postal ballot**.

2 **What are the various functions of the ECI? Which is most important for free and fair elections? Explain.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Functions:

- Creates and revises the electoral roll (including SIR).
- Decides the schedule and dates of elections.
- Registers political parties, recognises national/state parties and allots symbols; settles disputes as a quasi-judicial body.
- Ensures free, fair and inclusive elections (Model Code of Conduct, EVMs, VVPAT, accessibility, apps like cVIGIL).

Most important (sample view): **ensuring free and fair elections**, because if fairness is not ensured, public confidence in elections weakens and their democratic value is reduced. (A correct electoral roll is also a strong answer: only those on the roll can vote.)

3 **Elections are the soul of a democracy. Do you agree? Why or why not?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Yes, I agree.

- They give every citizen an equal voice in forming the government.
- They keep representatives accountable; a government must seek a fresh mandate every five years.
- They give the government legitimacy and allow peaceful change.

But elections alone are not enough: they must be free, fair, inclusive and trustworthy.

4 **Explain at least three differences between national and state/regional political parties.**

✔ ANSWER

National party	State/regional party
Has influence in many states	Has influence mainly in one state
Gets 6% votes in 4 or more states + 4 Lok Sabha seats, or 2% of Lok Sabha seats from 3 states, or is a state party in 4 states	Gets 6% votes + 2 Assembly seats, or 3% of Assembly seats/3 seats, or 8% votes in that state, etc.
Focuses on national issues (defence, economy, foreign policy)	Focuses on regional issues, language and culture of the state
Its symbol is reserved all over India	Its symbol is reserved only in that state

5 **Why should you vote? Arrange in descending order of your choice and give reasons: (a) Opportunity to choose my representative (b) Makes me a responsible person (c) Opportunity to change the non-performing representative (d) Strengthens democracy**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample order: **d → a → c → b**.

- (d) Every vote strengthens democracy and gives the government legitimacy.

- (a) I choose who will make decisions on my behalf.
- (c) I can hold leaders accountable by voting out a non-performer.
- (b) Voting is a right and a duty, so it makes me a responsible citizen.

6 **What is the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) initiative of the ECI? Explain its objectives and necessity.**

✔ ANSWER

SIR is a drive by the ECI to **update, verify and correct the electoral rolls**.

Objectives:

- No eligible citizen is left out, especially young voters who have just turned 18.
- No ineligible person is included; names are deleted for death, change of residence, duplicate enrolment or being permanently untraceable.
- Claims and objections are settled before the final roll is published.

Necessity: only those on the roll can vote, so a correct roll is needed for free and fair elections.

7 **Match the political party with its symbol (symbols shown in the book: hand, elephant, broom, book, hammer-sickle-star, lotus).**

AAP · BJP · BSP · CPI (M) · INC · NPP

✔ ANSWER

Party	Symbol
Aam Aadmi Party (AAP)	Broom
Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)	Lotus
Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP)	Elephant
Communist Party of India (Marxist)	Hammer, sickle and star
Indian National Congress (INC)	Hand
National People's Party (NPP)	Book

8 (a) **Case study (Ishani votes for the first time). What initiatives were taken by the ECI to enable the voters to cast their vote?**

✔ ANSWER

- Online voter registration through the ECI portal.
- Polling station guarded by police for safety.
- Wheelchair and volunteers for her disabled brother.
- Identity verified with an alternative document.
- VVPAT slip to check the vote.
- Voting from home for her 89-year-old grandmother.

8 (b) **If Ishani voted without her Voter ID or Aadhaar card, which other document might she be carrying?**

✔ ANSWER

Any ECI-approved photo ID, e.g. **passport, driving licence, PAN card**, bank/post office passbook with photo, MGNREGA job card, or a government service ID card with photo.

8 (c) **Cite examples of violations of the Model Code of Conduct.**

✔ ANSWER

- Campaigners distributing pamphlets and raising slogans in the market on the day before the election (campaigning must stop 48 hours before polling).
- Wall writing and posters pasted everywhere (defacing public property).

8 (d) **Give a suitable title to the passage.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

“Ishani’s First Vote” or “No Voter to Be Left Behind”.

8 (e) **Find out how the police and army personnel cast their votes.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **Army personnel** are service voters: they vote by postal ballot through **ETPBS**, or through a proxy (classified service voters).
- **Police and other staff on election duty** vote by postal ballot or at a facilitation centre (using an Election Duty Certificate where they are on duty).

9 (a) **Countries A (multi-party), B (one political party), C (monarchy, no voting). What is the difference between having a voting right in a multi-party system and in a single-party system?**

✔ ANSWER

- In a **multi-party system** (Country A) voters have real choices among parties and can change the government.
- In a **single-party system** (Country B) people can vote but have no real choice, so the vote cannot change the government and leaders are less accountable.

9 (b) **In which of the above countries would you like to stay and why?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Country A. Even with an average standard of living, it has periodic elections, voting rights and many parties, so people have real choice, freedom and accountable government. Countries B and C may be richer but people have little or no say.

10 **What are the challenges to conducting free and fair elections?**

✔ ANSWER

- Huge scale: over 96.8 crore voters (2024), thousands of polling stations, hundreds of parties, diverse regions.
- Misinformation and fake news.
- Intimidation of voters.
- Influence of money, gifts and personal favours; appeals on religion or caste.
- Inaccurate counting and difficulty in reaching the booth for some voters.

The ECI addresses these through RPA 1950 and 1951, the Model Code of Conduct, EVMs, VVPAT and awareness campaigns.

11 **On the Stage: role-play a school election (Head Girl, Head Boy, Sports Captain) with an Election Commissioner, Returning Officer, Polling Agent, Candidate, Campaigner, Polling Officer, Police Personnel and Journalist.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Election Commissioner: announces schedule and code of conduct.
- Returning Officer: accepts nominations, checks them, declares results.
- Candidates and campaigners: present promises fairly, no gifts or false claims.
- Polling officers: check names on the voter list, mark ink, give secret ballot.
- Polling agents: watch voting and counting for their candidate.
- Police: keep order and safety at the booth.
- Journalist: reports the process and results honestly.

12 **Make videos or audios on: My Vote My Nation; No Voter to be Left Behind; How to Eliminate the Ill of Money Power, etc.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample idea (audio, 1 minute, “My Vote My Nation”): a first-time voter explains how to register (Voter Helpline App), why every vote counts, and ends with the Voters’ Pledge: vote fearlessly, without being influenced by religion, caste, language or any inducement.

13 **Select one party. Prepare a comparative chart of the last two State Assembly elections: promises in manifesto, % votes, seats won, women who contested, women elected (cite sources).**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Make a table with columns: Detail | Election 1 (year) | Election 2 (year) | Source.

Rows: (a) promises, (b) vote %, (c) seats won, (d) women contestants, (e) women elected.

Take numbers from the ECI results website (eci.gov.in) and promises from the party’s manifesto; mention newspaper names and dates.

14 **Do you think ‘One Nation, One Election’ can improve the efficiency of the electoral process? Discuss advantages and limitations.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Advantages: lower cost of elections; less time of officials, police and teachers on election duty; the Model Code of Conduct does not stop development work again and again; governments can focus on governance; may raise turnout.

Limitations: needs constitutional changes; hard if a state government falls mid-term; national issues may overshadow local ones; very large machinery (EVMs, staff, security) needed at one time; may weaken federal spirit.

Conclusion (sample): it can improve efficiency if these problems are solved with wide agreement.

🎉 **Chapter 7 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**